

Chicago

The best of the best in the city — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition.

20

Michelin stars
in the 2025
selection —
Smyth alone at
three

33

Bib Gourmand
restaurants

1907

the
Green
Mill —
jazz
since

803

places
across
twelve lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 51

Speakeasies 50

Rooftops 50

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Scene 50

Nightlife 50

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow = you've been ★ Michelin star **Bib** Bib Gourmand (50 Best №1) bar ranking GS Michelin Green Star

JBF James Beard winner or nominee **closed** verify = check before you go

Resy Tock OpenTable SevenRooms where to book **Amex** ✓ Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JBF 2026 James Beard nominee \$-\$\$\$\$ rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic Date night Casual

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, the Chicago Tribune, Chicago Magazine, Eater Chicago, OpenTable, Resy, Tock and the Michelin Guide. Michelin marks reflect the 2025 Chicago selection, the most recent at time of printing; only stars, Green Stars and Bib Gourmands are shown. Cover: the Gold Coast and the Hancock from Oak Street Beach, via Pexels.

Tony *Abraham*

Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

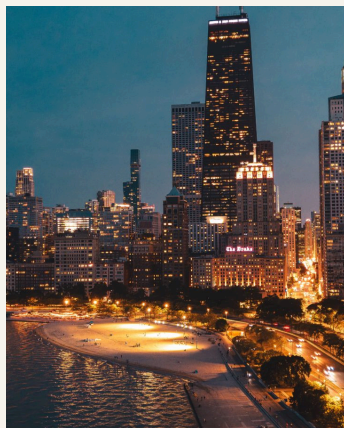
Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listede ville* / *Chicago* is the fifth city guide — the city that invented Tock, deep dish, and the depression dog, and where the hot-dog stand and the three-star are argued about with equal seriousness.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle to follow.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.



Honor Roll · 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A drive-up beef stand, a goat-birria counter, a rib-tip window on 75th Street and the city's only three-star kitchen, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

Chicago is the best eating city in America per dollar, and the Guide agrees — more Bibs than any city but New York, most of them under \$30. These ten are where Michelin, the local critics and tens of thousands of Google reviews all point the same way, and where the food, not the room, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

Smyth

West Loop; John and Karen Shields

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Shields' West Loop tasting room is the city's only three-star kitchen and the rare one where the food, not the theatre, carries the evening: farm-driven, quietly strange, precise. Alinea has the fame; this has the plates.

Order The tasting — there is only one. The quail and the Japanese milk bread are the courses people write home about; take the wine pairing.

01

Kasama

Ukrainian Village; the morning pastry

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

Two stars for the Filipino tasting menu at night; by day, a bakery counter with a line down Winchester Avenue for the best pastries in Chicago. Both halves earn the roll. The Bear made it famous; the food was already there.

Order Daytime: the ube-huckleberry basque cake, a truffle croissant and the longganisa breakfast sandwich (order ahead online to skip the line). Night: the tasting, booked the day Tock opens.

02

Galit

03

Lincoln Park; Zach Engel

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Zach Engel's Lincoln Park room does modern Israeli cooking with a star and no fuss: pita from a wood oven, salatim that change daily, a hummus that regulars order on every visit. The pick-your-own set menu keeps the price sane.

Order The hummus and salatim to start, the falafel, then whatever the grill has that night. Take the set menu and let the table share.

Avec

04

West Loop / River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Paul Kahan's West Loop wine bar has been the city's most-copied room since 2003 and still holds a Bib. Communal tables, a wood oven, and one dish — chorizo-stuffed dates wrapped in bacon — that Chicago would riot over if it left.

Order The bacon-wrapped dates, the focaccia, the whole roasted fish or the brandade, and a bottle from the Mediterranean end of the list.

Birrieria Zaragoza

05

Uptown

Bib \$ Walk-in

Late night Group

One thing, done perfectly: goat birria, Jalisco-style, roasted then simmered, served with hand-pressed tortillas and a bowl of consommé. Counter seating only, a Bib every year, and a 4.7 on Google that nothing else on this roll can match.

Order The large plate, bone-in, with extra consommé; make your own tacos. Horchata, then the flan.

Sun Wah BBQ

06

Uptown; the Beijing duck

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

A Cantonese barbecue house on Broadway that turns a whole roast duck into a three-act meal: carved tableside onto bao, then fried rice from the carcass, then soup. Loud, fast and the city's most beloved feast for four.

Order The Beijing Duck Dinner — call ahead to reserve the duck — with extra bao. Add the roast pork and a plate of the beef chow fun while you wait.

Johnnie's Beef

07

Elmwood Park

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Italian beef the rest of the city measures itself against: thin-sliced, dipped, on a roll that dissolves halfway through. Cash, a line out the door, no seats to speak of, and the lemon ice afterward is part of the ritual.

Order Beef, hot, dipped. A combo (beef and sausage) if you're hungry. Lemon Italian ice to finish, eaten standing at the car.

Carnitas Uruapan

08

Pilsen; since 1975

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Michoacán-style carnitas since 1975, cooked in copper and chopped to order by the pound at a counter that hands out samples while you wait. The best pork in the city, in a room that smells like it.

Order Carnitas by the pound with tortillas, salsa and pickled jalapeños, plus a slab of chicharrón. Weekends, add the corundas.

Pequod's

09

Lincoln Park; the caramelized crust

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

If you eat one deep-dish, eat this one: the pan is lined with cheese that caramelizes black against the iron, so the crust is the point rather than the price of admission. Sixteen thousand Google reviews say the same thing.

Order A deep-dish with sausage, half if there are two of you; ask for the crust well done. Order it the moment you sit — it takes forty minutes.

Lem's Bar-B-Q

10

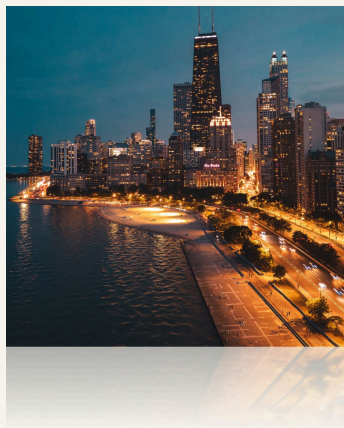
Chatham; since 1954

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

South Side barbecue from an aquarium smoker on 75th Street since 1954: rib tips and hot links, charred and chopped, under a tangy, vinegar-forward sauce, sold through a window with room for five inside. Take-out only; eat in the car like everyone else.

Order The rib-tip-and-hot-link combo, sauce on, with the fries that come under it. Extra sauce on the side.



Cafés · 51 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Logan Square's Bib row, Fulton Market's counters, and the neighborhood rooms Chicago actually eats in on a Tuesday.

Logan Square is the neighborhood-restaurant capital of America: Lula, Daisies, Lardon, Cellar Door, Table Donkey and Stick, Mi Tocaya, Superkhana — seven Bibs on a two-mile stretch. Fulton Market and the Publican family cover the west side.

Why these Picked for the room you'd return to on a weeknight. Seventeen Bibs are on this list plus three starred rooms; Kasama's daytime bakery-café is the two-star you can walk into.

Lula Cafe

Logan Square; since 1999

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Kasama daytime

Ukrainian Village; the bakery-café

★★ \$\$
Date night Casual

Daisies

Logan Square; pasta

Bib GS \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Lardon

Logan Square; charcuterie all day

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Cellar Door Provisions

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Table, Donkey and Stick

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Giant

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Mi Tocaya Antojería

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Superkhana International

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Dear Margaret

Lakeview; French-Canadian

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Sochi Saigonese Kitchen

Lakeview

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Chilam Balam

Lakeview

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Avec

West Loop / River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

The Publican

Fulton Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Publican Quality Meats

Fulton Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Rose Mary

Fulton Market; Joe Flamm

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Monteverde

West Loop; Sarah Grueneberg

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Obélix

River North; the Bouchon brothers

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Le Bouchon

Bucktown; since 1993

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Mirra

Bucktown

Bib new 2025 Bib \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Mott St

Wicker Park

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Big Star

Wicker Park / Wrigleyville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Sótano

River North; below Frontera

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Frontera Grill

River North; Rick Bayless

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Ciccio Mio

River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Gilt Bar

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Au Cheval

West Loop; the burger

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bavette's

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Nadu

Lincoln Park; South Indian

Bib new 2025 Bib \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Galit

Lincoln Park; Zach Engel

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Boka

Lincoln Park

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Perilla

West Loop; Korean

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Cariño

Uptown; Norman Fenton

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Andros Taverna

Logan Square; Greek

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

HaiSous

Pilsen; Vietnamese

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Pleasant House Pub

Pilsen; pies

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Kimski

Bridgeport; Korean-Polish

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Virtue

Hyde Park; Erick Williams, 2022 JBF Best

Chef Great Lakes

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Munno Pizzeria & Bistro

Andersonville

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Parachute

Andersonville; reborn

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Boonie's Filipino

North Center

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sifr

River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sol de Mexico

Belmont Cragin

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Birrieria Zaragoza

Uptown

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

Kie-Gol-Lanee

Uptown; Oaxacan

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bloom Plant Based Kitchen

Wicker Park

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tortello

Wicker Park; fresh pasta

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Apolonia

South Loop

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Longman & Eagle

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Goa

River North; Indian

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

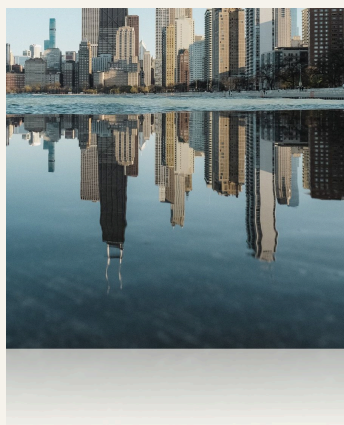
[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Pompette

Bucktown; wine bar

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)



Speakeasies · 50 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

*Through a record shop, behind a mural, beneath the Aviary.
Ranked, loosely, by the drink.*

Chicago's hidden bars are literal: Dorian's through a record shop, the Violet Hour behind a mural, the Office beneath the Aviary, Milk Room with eight seats. The Green Mill has Capone's tunnels.

Why these Ranked by the drink. Kumiko is the 2024 James Beard Outstanding Bar; Best Intentions, Meadowlark and Bisous hold 50 Best rankings. Lost Lake and Danny's are listed closed because the city still mourns them.

Kumiko

West Loop; Julia Momosé

NA50 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Milk Room

Chicago Athletic Association; 8 seats

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Violet Hour

Wicker Park; behind the mural

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Meadowlark

Logan Square

NA50 2025 #38 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bisous

River North; wine + cocktails

NA50 2025 #39 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Best Intentions

Logan Square

NA50 2025 #25 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Office

beneath The Aviary, Fulton Market;
reservation only

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Aviary

Fulton Market; Alinea group

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Dorian's

Wicker Park; through the record shop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bordel

Wicker Park; upstairs, burlesque

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Sportsman's Club

Ukrainian Village; the daily four

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Scofflaw

Logan Square; gin

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Billy Sunday

Logan Square; amaro

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lost Lake

closed

Three Dots and a Dash

River North; tiki, down the alley

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Sótano

River North; below Frontera

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Estereo

Logan Square; Latin, open-air

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lazy Bird

The Hoxton, Fulton Market; basement

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Green Mill

Uptown; since 1907; Capone's booth

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

California Clipper

Humboldt Park

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Rainbo Club

Ukrainian Village; the photo booth

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Danny's Tavern

closed

The Whistler

Logan Square; tiny, jazz

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Ludlow Liquors

Avondale

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar DeVille

West Town

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Chef's Special Cocktail Bar

Bucktown; Chinese-American + drinks

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Nine Bar

Chinatown; inside Moon Palace

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Jerry's?

closed

Dove's Luncheonette

Wicker Park; the counter

\$\$

Date night Late night

Untitled Supper Club

River North; the vault

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Fulton Market's Nobody's Darling

Andersonville; Black-owned, JBF
Outstanding Bar 2023 semifinalist

\$\$

Date night Late night

Nobody's Darling

Andersonville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Marchesa?

closed

Bar Ramone?

closed ; use Broken English (Old Town; tequila)

Ombra

Andersonville; aperitivo

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Simone's

Pilsen

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Punch House

Pilsen; basement of Dusek's

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Thalia Hall's bars

Pilsen

\$\$

Date night Late night

Debonair Social Club

Wicker Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Emporium

Wicker Park / Logan Square; arcade bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Headquarters Beercade

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Game Room

Chicago Athletic Association

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Drawing Room

Chicago Athletic Association

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Cherry Circle Room

Chicago Athletic Association

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Lupo

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Duck Inn

Bridgeport; the duck

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Maria's Packaged Goods

Bridgeport; liquor store + bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Kaiser Tiger

West Loop; beer garden

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Old Town Ale House

Old Town; the paintings

\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Skylark

Pilsen

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night



Rooftops · 50 places

Rooftop bars

Over Millennium Park, over the river, over the world's largest rooftop bar on Navy Pier.

Cindy's over Millennium Park is the one everyone wants; Offshore on Navy Pier is the largest rooftop bar in the world; the Riverwalk does the same job at water level in summer.

Why these Chosen for the view first, stretched to include the beach bars and the Riverwalk, which close by October. Wrigleyville's rooftops are on because they're a civic institution.

Cindy's

Chicago Athletic Association; over Millennium Park

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

LH Rooftop

LondonHouse; the Tribune Tower view

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Cerise

Virgin Hotels

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Apogee

Dana Hotel, River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Drumbar

Raffaello, Streeterville

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

J. Parker

Hotel Lincoln, Lincoln Park

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Upstairs at the Gwen

Michigan Ave

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Offshore

Navy Pier; the largest rooftop bar in the world

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Raised

Renaissance, the river

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Utopian Tailgate

Second City, Old Town

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Cabra

The Hoxton; Stephanie Izard's Peruvian rooftop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Boleo

Kimpton Gray; the retractable roof

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

NoMI Garden

Park Hyatt

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

The Signature Room

closed

Aba

Fulton Market; the terrace

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Ēma

River North; the terrace

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Beatnik on the River

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Tiny Tapp

Riverwalk; seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

City Winery Riverwalk

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Northman Beer & Cider Garden

Riverwalk

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Island Party Hut

Riverwalk

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Streeterville Social

Loews

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

The Robey's Up Room

Wicker Park; the tower

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Cabana Club

The Robey; pool

\$\$\$
Date night Group

Recess

West Loop; outdoor

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Parlor Pizza Bar rooftops

multiple

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Fulton Market Kitchen?

closed ; use Kaiser Tiger beer garden (West Loop)

Sky Pilot

\$\$\$
Date night Group

ROOF on theWit

the Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Nobu Chicago rooftop

Fulton Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

The Godfrey's I/O

River North; the retractable roof

\$\$\$
Date night Group

VU Rooftop

South Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Wrigleyville rooftops

the Cubs; seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Murphy's Bleachers

Wrigleyville; roof deck

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Old Crow Smokehouse rooftop

Wrigleyville

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Castaways

North Avenue Beach; seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

The Dock at Montrose Beach

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Shore Club

North Avenue Beach; seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Ohio Street Beach's Caffè Oliva

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Big Star's patio

Wicker Park

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Parson's Chicken & Fish

Logan Square / Lincoln Park; the patio

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Sheffield's beer garden

Lakeview

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Revolution Brewing's taproom

Avondale

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Hopleaf's garden

Andersonville

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Hubbard Inn's roof

River North

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Moe's Cantina rooftop

River North

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Lakeview's Bar Cocina?

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Bar Sol at Navy Pier

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Group

Terrace 16

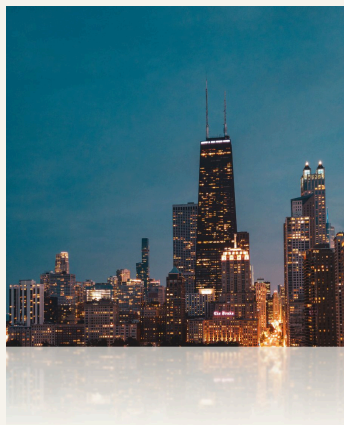
Trump International; the river

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Rooftop at the Emily Hotel

Fulton Market; Selva

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group



Bars · 113 places

Bars

A James Beard Outstanding Bar, three 50 Best entries, and the taverns and blues rooms that made the city.

A serious cocktail city since the Violet Hour opened in 2007, with a tavern culture older than any of it and the blues rooms that gave the world Chess Records.

Why these Ranked and recognized first, then institutions, hotel bars, dives, wine, beer. The Green Mill, Billy Goat and Old Town Ale House are on for history; Hopleaf and Map Room for the beer.

Ranked & recognized

Kumiko

West Loop

NA50 JBF Outstanding Bar 2024 winner

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Best Intentions

Logan Square

NA50 2025 #25 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Meadowlark

Logan Square

NA50 2025 #38 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bisous

River North

NA50 2025 #39 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Milk Room

Chicago Athletic Association

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Violet Hour

Wicker Park; JBF Outstanding Bar Program 2015

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Aviary

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Cocktail institutions

The Office

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Dorian's

Wicker Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Sportsman's Club

Ukrainian Village

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Scofflaw

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Billy Sunday

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Three Dots and a Dash

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Sótano

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Estereo

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lazy Bird

Fulton Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Whistler

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Ludlow Liquors

Avondale

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar DeVille

West Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Chef's Special Cocktail Bar

Bucktown

Bib \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Nine Bar

Chinatown

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Nobody's Darling

Andersonville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Ombra

Andersonville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Broken English

Old Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Punch House

Pilsen

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Simone's

Pilsen

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bordel

Wicker Park

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Lupo

River North

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Untitled Supper Club

River North

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cherry Circle Room

CAA

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Drawing Room

CAA

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Game Room

CAA

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Longman & Eagle bar

Logan Square

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lost Lake

closed

Marchesa

closed

Danny's

closed

Bar Cargo

closed

Hotel & classic bars

Milk Room / Cherry Circle Room

CAA

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cindy's

CAA

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Coq d'Or

The Drake; since 1933

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

The Palm Court

The Drake

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

NoMI

Park Hyatt

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Bar at the Peninsula

The Bar

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Pops for Champagne

River North

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Drumbar

Raffaello

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Apogee

Dana

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cerise

Virgin

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

LH Rooftop

LondonHouse

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lazy Bird

Hoxton

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Up Room

The Robey

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Boleo

Kimpton Gray

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Vol. 39

Kimpton Gray

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Library at the Gwen

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Ada Street

Bucktown; the backyard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

[Historic / dive / neighborhood](#)

Green Mill

Uptown; 1907

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Old Town Ale House

Old Town

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Billy Goat Tavern

lower Michigan Ave; since 1934

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Green Door Tavern

River North; since 1921

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Twin Anchors

Old Town; ribs, Sinatra's spot

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rainbo Club

Ukrainian Village

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

California Clipper

Humboldt Park

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Delilah's

Lincoln Park; whiskey + punk

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Gold Star Bar

Wicker Park

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rossi's

River North; dive

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Carol's Pub

Uptown; country

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Hideout

West Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Empty Bottle

Ukrainian Village

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cole's

Logan Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Maria's Packaged Goods

Bridgeport

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Duck Inn

Bridgeport

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bernice's Tavern

Bridgeport

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Skylark

Pilsen

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Podlasie Club

Avondale; Polish disco

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Ola's Liquor

Ukrainian Village

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Reggies

South Loop

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Kingston Mines

Lincoln Park; blues

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Buddy Guy's Legends

South Loop

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rosa's Lounge

Logan Square; blues

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Schubas

Lakeview

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Hopleaf

Andersonville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Casual](#)

Simon's Tavern

Andersonville; since 1934

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

[Wine bars](#)

Bisous

River North

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Rootstock

Humboldt Park

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Pompette

Bucktown

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Webster's Wine Bar

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Pastoral

Lakeview

verify \$\$

Date night Late night

Red & White Wines

Bucktown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Income Tax

Edgewater

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Cellar Door Provisions

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Table, Donkey and Stick

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Daisies

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Ombra

Andersonville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Lupo

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Beer

Hopleaf

Andersonville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Casual

Map Room

Bucktown

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Sheffield's

Lakeview

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Revolution Brewing

Logan Square / Avondale

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Half Acre

North Center / Lincoln Park

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Goose Island

Fulton St / Wrigleyville

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Marz Community Brewing

Bridgeport

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Off Color Brewing

Lincoln Park; Mousetrap

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Pilot Project

Logan Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Middle Brow Bungalow

Logan Square; beer + pizza + bread

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Dovetail

Ravenswood

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Begyle

Ravenswood

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Spiteful

Ravenswood

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Metropolitan Brewing

Avondale; the river

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Kaiser Tiger

West Loop

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Rooftop / view bars that double as great bars

Cindy's

CAA

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Apogee

Dana

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Drumbar

Raffaello

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

J. Parker

Lincoln Hotel

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

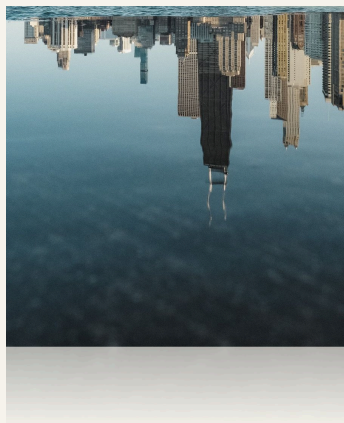
Date night Late night

Cabra

Hoxton

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night



Coffee · 50 places

Coffee shops

Intelligentsia's hometown, Sawada's military latte, and the bakeries that double as the best cafés.

Intelligentsia started third-wave coffee here in 1995; Metric, Dark Matter and Sawada carry it on; Lou Mitchell's has been giving away Milk Duds since 1923.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. The bakeries that double as cafés — Kasama, Lost Larson, Loba, Publican Quality Bread — are the best mornings in the city.

Intelligentsia

Broadway / Millennium Park / multiple;
born here 1995

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Metric Coffee

West Town; roaster

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sawada Coffee

West Loop; military latte

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Dark Matter Coffee

Star Lounge, Ukrainian Village / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Ipsento

Bucktown; Ipsento 606

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Big Shoulders Coffee

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Passion House

Logan Square / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Hero Coffee

the Loop / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Dollop Coffee

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

The Wormhole

Wicker Park; DeLorean

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sip of Hope

Logan Square

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

La Colombe

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Kasama

Ukrainian Village; the morning pastry

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Lost Larson

Andersonville / Wicker Park

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Publican Quality Bread

Fulton Market

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Loba Pastry + Coffee

Lakeview

\$
Sweets Brunch

Floriole

Lincoln Park

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

La Fournette

Old Town

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Hewn

Evanston

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Middle Brow

Logan Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Jumping Bean

Pilsen; since 1994

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Café Marie-Jeanne?

closed

Ellipsis Coffeehouse

Edgewater

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Fairgrounds

Bucktown / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bru Chicago

Lincoln Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Gaslight Coffee Roasters

Logan Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Collectivo Coffee

Milwaukee import; multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Stan's Donuts & Coffee

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Do-Rite Donuts

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Doughnut Vault

River North

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Firecakes

River North / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bombobar

West Loop; hotter chocolate

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Café Selmarie

Lincoln Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Coffee & Tea Exchange

Lakeview; since 1975

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffè Umbria

Loop / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bridgeport Coffee Company

Bridgeport

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sputnik Coffee

Pilsen; roaster

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sip & Savor

Bronzeville

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Build Coffee

Woodlawn

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Plein Air Café

Hyde Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Medici on 57th

Hyde Park; the bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Valois

Hyde Park; cafeteria, Obama's spot

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ann Sather

Lakeview / multiple; cinnamon rolls

\$ OpenTable

Sweets Brunch

Lou Mitchell's

West Loop; since 1923; free Milk Duds

\$\$ OpenTable

Sweets Brunch

Manny's Cafeteria & Delicatessen

South Loop; since 1942

\$\$ OpenTable

Sweets Brunch

Eleven City Diner

South Loop

\$ OpenTable

Sweets Brunch

Beatrix

multiple

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Goddess and the Baker

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafecito

multiple; Cuban

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ipseinto 606

Bucktown; on the trail

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Restaurants · 187 places

Restaurants

Twenty Michelin stars, thirty-three Bibs, the deep-dish and tavern-style argument, and the Devon Avenue, Pilsen and Uptown kitchens that are the actual city.

Twenty stars in the 2025 selection — Smyth alone at three, Alinea moved down to two beside Ever, Oriole and Kasama — and thirty-three Bibs, with Mirra, Nadu and Taqueria Chingón added. Around them: the steakhouses, the pizza argument, and the neighborhood kitchens of Pilsen, Uptown, Devon Avenue and Bridgeport.

Why these Grouped by distinction, then the new guard, then the classics. Tock was invented here (for Alinea), so the counters run on it. The Bibs and the Logan Square block are where to read slowly.

Michelin ★★★

Smyth

West Loop; John and Karen Shields

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Michelin ★★

Alinea

Lincoln Park; Grant Achatz

★★ (down from ★★★) \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ever

Fulton Market; Curtis Duffy; Michelin Service Award 2025

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Oriole

West Loop; Noah Sandoval; the freight elevator

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Kasama

Ukrainian Village; Genie Kwon & Tim Flores; promoted 2025

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Michelin ★

Atelier

Lincoln Square

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Boka

Lincoln Park

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Cariño

Uptown

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

EL Ideas

Douglas Park; Phillip Foss

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Elske

West Loop

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night

Esmé

Lincoln Park; Jenner Tomaska

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Feld

West Town; Jake Potashnick

★ GS new 2025 star \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Galit

Lincoln Park

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Indienne

River North; Suján Sarkar

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mako

West Loop; omakase

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Moody Tongue

South Loop; the brewery tasting menu

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Next

West Loop; the menu changes entirely

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Schwa

Wicker Park; Michael Carlson; the phone

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sepia

West Loop

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Topolobampo

River North; Rick Bayless

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Daisies

Logan Square

Bib GS \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bib Gourmand (2025)

Mirra

Bucktown

Bib new 2025 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Nadu

Lincoln Park

Bib new 2025 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Taqueria Chingón

West Loop / Bucktown

Bib new 2025 \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Lula Cafe

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Avec

West Loop

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Frontera Grill

River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Virtue

Hyde Park

Bib \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Lardon

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Cellar Door Provisions

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Table, Donkey and Stick

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Mi Tocaya Antojería

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Superkhana International

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sochi Saigonese Kitchen

Lakeview

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Chilam Balam

Lakeview

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Ciccio Mio

River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Mott St

Wicker Park

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Perilla

West Loop

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pleasant House Pub

Pilsen

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Munno

Andersonville

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Boonie's Filipino

North Center

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sifr

River North

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sol de Mexico

Belmont Cragin

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Birrieria Zaragoza

Uptown

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

Bloom Plant Based Kitchen

Wicker Park

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Tortello

Wicker Park

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Apolonia

South Loop

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Chef's Special Cocktail Bar

Bucktown

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

HaiSous

Pilsen

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Andros Taverna

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Kie-Gol-Lanee

Uptown

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Rose Mary

Fulton Market

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Cafe Spiaggia

closed

Proxi

closed

Passerotto

closed

Fat Rice

closed

The new guard

Obélix

River North

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Bar Goa

River North

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Parachute

Andersonville; reborn

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Nine Bar / Moon Palace

Chinatown

new \$\$

Casual Date night

Pompette

Bucktown

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Warlord

Avondale; live fire

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Tre Dita

St. Regis; Tuscan

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Miru

St. Regis; Japanese

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Adalina

Gold Coast

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Alston

Gold Coast

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Akahoshi Ramen

Logan Square

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Wherewithall

closed

Bazaar Meat by José Andrés

Bank of America Tower

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Jaleo Chicago

River North

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Nobu Chicago

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Momotaro

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Time Out Market Chicago

Fulton Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Classics & must-visits

Girl & the Goat

West Loop; Stephanie Izard

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Duck Duck Goat

West Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Cabra

The Hoxton

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Little Goat Diner

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Au Cheval

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bavette's Bar & Boeuf

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Gilt Bar

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Maple & Ash

Gold Coast

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night Group

Swift & Sons

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

RPM Steak / RPM Italian

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Gibsons Bar & Steakhouse

Gold Coast; since 1989

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night Group

Chicago Cut

River North; the river

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Boeufhaus

Ukrainian Village

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Prime & Provisions

the Loop

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Monteverde

West Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

The Publican

Fulton Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Avec

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Blackbird

closed

Longman & Eagle

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Lula Cafe

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Giant

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Big Star

Wicker Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Le Bouchon

Bucktown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Bistro Campagne

Lincoln Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

North Pond

Lincoln Park; the pond

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Frontera Grill / Topolobampo

River North

\$\$

Casual Date night

XOCO

closed

Carnitas Uruapan

Pilsen; since 1975

\$ Walk-in

Casual

5 Rabanitos

Pilsen

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Nuevo Leon

closed

Sun Wah BBQ

Uptown; the Beijing duck

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Lao Sze Chuan

Chinatown; Tony Hu

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

MingHin Cuisine

Chinatown; dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Qing Xiang Yuan Dumplings

Chinatown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Cai

Chinatown; dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Jade Court?

closed ; use Chi Cafe (Chinatown; late)

Han 202

Bridgeport; BYOB

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

HaiSous

Pilsen

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pho 777

Uptown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Tank Noodle

Uptown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Nha Hang Viet Nam

Uptown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Demera

Uptown; Ethiopian

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Ras Dashen

Edgewater; Ethiopian

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Devon Avenue: Hema's Kitchen

Indian

\$\$

Casual Date night

Devon Avenue: Uru-Swati

vegetarian

\$\$

Casual Date night

Devon Avenue: Sabri Nihari

Pakistani

\$\$

Casual Date night

Rooh Chicago

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Vajra

West Town; Nepalese

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Cumin

Wicker Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Kimski

Bridgeport

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Jeong

West Town; Korean tasting

verify \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

San Soo Gab San

Lincoln Square; Korean BBQ, 24h

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Cho Sun Ok

North Center; Korean BBQ

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Jin Ju

Andersonville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Isla Pilipina

Lincoln Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bayan Ko

Ravenswood; Filipino-Cuban

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Omakase Yume

West Loop

verify \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Kyōten

Logan Square; omakase, Otto Phan

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sushi-san

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Momotaro

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Roka Akor

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Wasabi

Logan Square; ramen

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Greek Islands

Greektown; since 1971

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Athena

Greektown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Avli

Lincoln Park / River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Ēma

River North

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Aba

Fulton Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Pequod's

Lincoln Park; the caramelized crust

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Lou Malnati's

multiple; deep dish

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Pizano's

multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Giordano's

multiple; stuffed

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Spacca Napoli

Ravenswood; Neapolitan

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Coalfire

West Town

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Milly's Pizza in the Pan

Uptown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Bungalow by Middle Brow

Logan Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Paulie Gee's Logan Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Pat's Pizza

Lakeview; tavern-style

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Marie's Pizza & Liquors

Albany Park

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Gene & Jude's

River Grove; the hot dog

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Superdawg

Norwood Park; the drive-in

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Portillo's

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Wiener's Circle

Lincoln Park; the abuse

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Jim's Original

Maxwell Street; the Polish

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Al's Beef

Little Italy; since 1938

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Johnnie's Beef

Elmwood Park

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Mr. Beef

River North; The Bear

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Hot Doug's

closed

Kuma's Corner

Avondale; metal burgers

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Manny's

South Loop; corned beef

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Harold's Chicken

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Lem's Bar-B-Q

Chatham; since 1954

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Smoque BBQ

Irving Park

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Honey 1 BBQ

verify \$\$

Casual Date night

Calumet Fisheries

South Deering; smoked fish, JBF America's

Classic

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Valois

Hyde Park

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Virtue

Hyde Park

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Bronzeville: Pearl's Place

verify \$\$

Casual Date night

Papa's Cache Sabroso

Humboldt Park; the jibarito

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

La Bruquena

Humboldt Park; Puerto Rican

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Sultan's Market

Wicker Park

\$\$

Casual Date night

Podhalanka

Noble Square; Polish, since 1985

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Staropolska

Logan Square

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Red Apple Buffet?

closed ; use [Kasia's Deli \(Ukrainian Village\)](#)

Tufano's Vernon Park Tap

Little Italy; since 1930

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Rosebud

Little Italy

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Piccolo Sogno

West Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Mart Anthony's

West Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Twin Anchors

Old Town; ribs

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Original Pancake House

multiple; the Dutch baby

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Walker Bros.

Wilmette

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Lou Mitchell's

West Loop

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Ann Sather

Lakeview

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Bongo Room

multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

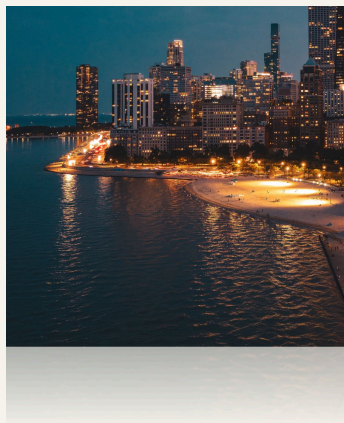
Casual Date night

Wildberry

the Loop / multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night



Brunch · 52 places

Brunch spots

Lula on Sunday, Kasama's morning line, and the pancake houses of the North Shore.

Sunday means Lula, the Kasama line, Longman & Eagle's whiskey with eggs, and the pancake houses that have been doing the Dutch baby since the 1950s.

Why these Kept to places that consistently top Resy and OpenTable's weekend demand plus the counters you walk into. Nine Bibs and a two-star do brunch here.

Lula Cafe

Logan Square

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Kasama

Ukrainian Village; the breakfast

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Brunch

Longman & Eagle

Logan Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Dove's Luncheonette

Wicker Park

\$\$

Brunch

m. henry

Andersonville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Ann Sather

Lakeview

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Bongo Room

Wicker Park / South Loop / Andersonville

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Wildberry Pancakes

the Loop / River North

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Original Pancake House

Lincoln Park / multiple

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Walker Bros.

Wilmette; the drive

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Lou Mitchell's

West Loop

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Kanela Breakfast Club

multiple

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Batter & Berries

Lincoln Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Tweet

Uptown

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Big Jones

Andersonville; Southern

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Southport Grocery

Lakeview

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Little Goat Diner

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Beatrix

multiple

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Bar Sótano weekend

River North

\$\$

Brunch

Frontera Grill brunch

River North

Bib \$\$

Brunch

Loba

Lakeview

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Floriole

Lincoln Park

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

La Fournette

Old Town

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Publican brunch

Fulton Market

\$\$

Brunch

Avec brunch

River North

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Cabra brunch

Hoxton

\$\$

Brunch

Rose Mary brunch

Fulton Market

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Cafe Ba-Ba-Reeba! brunch

Lincoln Park

\$\$

Brunch

Dear Margaret weekend

Lakeview

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Daisies brunch

Logan Square

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Giant brunch

Logan Square

\$\$

Brunch

Mi Tocaya weekend

Logan Square

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Sol de Mexico

Belmont Cragin

[Bib](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Birrieria Zaragoza

Uptown; Sunday

[Bib](#) \$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Carnitas Uruapan

Pilsen; Sunday morning

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Valois

Hyde Park

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Virtue brunch

Hyde Park

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Bronzeville's Peach's

Bronzeville

\$\$

Brunch

Manny's

South Loop

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Eleven City Diner

South Loop

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Yolk

multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Toast

Lincoln Park / Bucktown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Jam

closed

Nettare?

closed ; use Ina Mae Tavern (Wicker Park; New Orleans)

Ravinia

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Kie-Gol-Lanee weekend

Uptown

[Bib](#) \$\$

Brunch

Sun Wah

Uptown; dim sum hours

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

MingHin dim sum

Chinatown

\$\$

Brunch

Cai dim sum

Chinatown

\$\$

Brunch

Superdawg

the drive-in, any hour

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

The Drake's Palm Court tea

Gold Coast

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

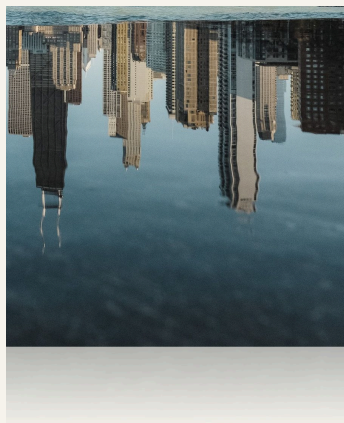
Brunch

Lost Larson

Andersonville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch



Off-beat · 50 places

Off-beat & only-in-Chicago

The depression dog, the dipped beef, the jibarito, mild sauce, and a tasting menu you reach by phoning a chef.

The depression dog at Gene & Jude's, the dipped beef at Al's, the jibarito in Humboldt Park, mild sauce on the South Side, and a Michelin-starred restaurant you reach by phoning the chef.

Why these Selected for singularity. Calumet Fisheries won a James Beard America's Classic; Schwa's phone and Oriole's freight elevator are on for the theater; the Sunday Maxwell Street Market is the best cheap meal in the city.

Gene & Jude's

River Grove; the depression dog

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Superdawg

Norwood Park; carhops since 1948

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Wiener's Circle

Lincoln Park; the char dog, the abuse

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Jim's Original

Maxwell Street; the Polish, since 1939

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Al's Beef

Little Italy; dipped, hot

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Johnnie's Beef

Elmwood Park

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mr. Beef

River North

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Portillo's

Clark Street original

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Vito & Nick's

Ashburn; tavern-style

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Pequod's

Lincoln Park

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Lou Malnati's

Lincolnwood original

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Calumet Fisheries

South Deering; JBF America's Classic 2010

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Harold's Chicken

the mild sauce

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Lem's Bar-B-Q

Chatham; rib tips

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Uncle Remus

Austin; mild sauce chicken

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Manny's

South Loop

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Valois

Hyde Park; "See Your Food"

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Billy Goat Tavern

lower Michigan; "cheezborger"

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Papa's Cache Sabroso

Humboldt Park; jibarito

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Carnitas Uruapan

Pilsen

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Birrieria Zaragoza

Uptown

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

Sun Wah BBQ

Uptown; the duck ceremony

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Qing Xiang Yuan Dumplings

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Chi Cafe

Chinatown; 3am

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Devon Avenue

the Indian-Pakistani strip

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Sabri Nihari

Devon

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Podhalanka

Noble Square

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Kasia's Deli

Ukrainian Village; pierogi

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Podlasie Club

Avondale

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Maxwell Street Market

Sunday; the tacos

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Maria's Packaged Goods

Bridgeport

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Kimski

Bridgeport

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Schwa

Wicker Park; call the phone, hope

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

Next

West Loop; the whole menu changes

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

Oriole

West Loop; the freight elevator

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

Moody Tongue

South Loop; a brewery with a Michelin star

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

EL Ideas

Douglas Park; BYOB fine dining

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

Milk Room

CAA; 8 seats, vintage spirits

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Casual

Green Mill

Uptown; the Capone tunnels

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Carol's Pub

Uptown; honky-tonk

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Old Town Ale House

the paintings

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Twin Anchors

Old Town

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Margie's Candies

Bucktown; since 1921

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Rainbow Cone

Beverly; since 1926

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Garrett Popcorn

the Chicago mix

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Nuts on Clark

Union Station

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hot Doug's

closed

Ravinia

the lawn, the picnic

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

The Riverwalk

Tiny Tapp, City Winery; summer

\$

Casual

Wrigley Field bleachers

an Old Style and a dog

\$

Casual



Bakeries · 50 places

Bakeries

Kasama's ube, Lost Larson's cardamom, paczki on Fat Tuesday, and Roeser's since 1911.

Kasama's ube pastries, Lost Larson's Scandinavian buns, Roeser's since 1911, and the Polish bakeries that sell a hundred thousand paczki on Fat Tuesday.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one signature item each. Old Fashioned Donuts in Roseland is on for the apple fritter; Ferrara and Scafuri for being older than the Cubs' last title before 2016.

Kasama

Ukrainian Village

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Lost Larson

Andersonville / Wicker Park; Scandinavian

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Publican Quality Bread

Fulton Market

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hewn

Evanston

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Middle Brow Bungalow

Logan Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Loba Pastry + Coffee

Lakeview

\$

Sweets Brunch

Floriole

Lincoln Park

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

La Fournette

Old Town

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Vanille Patisserie

Lincoln Park / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bittersweet Pastry Shop

Lakeview

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Alliance Bakery

Wicker Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Roeser's Bakery

Humboldt Park; since 1911

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Weber's Bakery

Garfield Ridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dinkel's

closed

Swedish Bakery

closed

Ann Sather

the cinnamon rolls

\$ OpenTable

Sweets Brunch

Mindy's Bakery

Wicker Park; Mindy Segal

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hoosier Mama Pie Company

West Town / Evanston

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bang Bang Pie & Biscuits

Logan Square / Ravenswood

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

First Slice Pie Café

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Do-Rite Donuts

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Stan's Donuts

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Doughnut Vault

River North

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Firecakes

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Old Fashioned Donuts

Roseland; the apple fritter

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Dat Donut

Chatham

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bombobar

West Loop

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Chiu Quon Bakery

Chinatown / Uptown; since 1986

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Saint Anna Bakery

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Tous les Jours

Chinatown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Paris Baguette

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Pticek & Son Bakery

Gage Park; paczki

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Delightful Pastries

Jefferson Park; paczki

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Oak Mill Bakery

Niles; Polish

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bennison's Bakery

Evanston

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Defloured

Andersonville; gluten-free

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Panadería Nuevo León

Pilsen

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

El Nopal Bakery

Pilsen

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Ferrara Bakery Chicago

Little Italy; since 1908

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Scafuri Bakery

Little Italy; since 1904

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

D'Amato's Bakery

West Town; since 1962

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Gonnella?

\$

Sweets Brunch

Beurrage

Pilsen

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sweet Mandy B's

Lincoln Park / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Molly's Cupcakes

Lincoln Park

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Baker Miller

Lincoln Square

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bread & Wine

closed

Kirschbaum's

Western Springs; the drive

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Levain Chicago

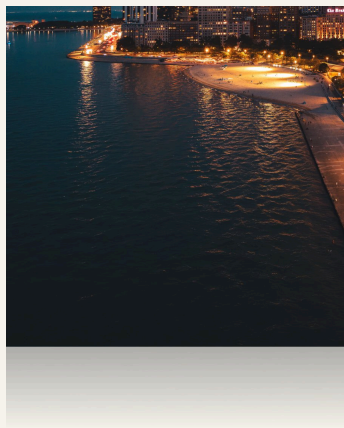
Wicker Park / Fulton Market

new \$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Lezza Spumoni & Desserts

Elmhurst; since 1905

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch



Dessert • 50 places

Dessert bars & sweets

For after — or instead of — dinner.

Margie's sundae since 1921, the Rainbow Cone since 1926, the Palmer House brownie since 1893, and Alinea's balloon.

Why these A mix of the destination and the institution. Half of this list is a century old, because Chicago keeps its sweets.

Margie's Candies

Bucktown; the sundae

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Rainbow Cone

Beverly / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Pretty Cool Ice Cream

Logan Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Jeni's

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Black Dog Gelato

Ukrainian Village / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Kurimu

Chinatown; Japanese soft serve

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Cone Gourmet Ice Cream

Wicker Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Zarlengo's

Elmwood Park; Italian ice

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Miko's Italian Ice

Logan Square / Bucktown; seasonal

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mario's Italian Lemonade

Little Italy; seasonal since 1954

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Garrett Popcorn

the Chicago mix

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Nuts on Clark

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Vosges Haut-Chocolat

Lincoln Park / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Katherine Anne Confections

Logan Square; caramels

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bombobar

West Loop

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Do-Rite Donuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Stan's Donuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Doughnut Vault

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Firecakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Old Fashioned Donuts

Roseland

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Hoosier Mama Pie

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bang Bang Pie

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mindy's Bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bittersweet

\$

Sweets

Vanille

\$

Sweets

Alliance Bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sweet Mandy B's

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Molly's Cupcakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Kasama's ube pastries

★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Lost Larson's cardamom bun

\$

Sweets

Loba's pastries

\$

Sweets

Ann Sather cinnamon rolls

\$

Sweets

Eli's Cheesecake

Norwood Park; the factory

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Portillo's chocolate cake shake

\$

Sweets

Sugar Bliss?

\$

Sweets

Bubble tea: Kung Fu Tea

Chinatown / multiple

\$

Sweets

Tsaocaa

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Joy Yee

Chinatown; the bubble tea original

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Chiu Quon's egg tarts

Chinatown

\$

Sweets

Saint Anna's tarts

Chinatown

\$

Sweets

Alinea's dessert course

Lincoln Park; the balloon

★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Smyth's dessert

West Loop

★★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Ever's finale

Fulton Market

★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Kasama's dessert course

★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

The Drake's afternoon tea

Gold Coast

\$

Sweets

Palmer House's brownie

the original, since 1893

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fannie May

multiple; since 1920

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Frango Mints

Macy's on State

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Beurrage

Pilsen

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Original Rainbow Cone at Navy Pier

seasonal

\$ Walk-in

Sweets



Scene · 50 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: Gold Coast steakhouses, Fulton Market's dining rooms, and the Drake.

Where the room is the point: Gibsons and Maple & Ash on the Gold Coast, the Fulton Market dining rooms, the Drake's Coq d'Or, and the starred rooms that are also a show.

Why these Steakhouses lead — this is Chicago — then Fulton Market's scene, then the tasting rooms where the experience is the point. Soho House is on because everyone will ask.

Maple & Ash

Gold Coast

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Gibsons

Gold Coast

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bavette's

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

RPM Steak

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

RPM Italian

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Swift & Sons

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Chicago Cut

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Prime & Provisions

the Loop

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Boeufhaus

Ukrainian Village

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bazaar Meat

the Loop

new \$\$\$

Group Date night

Jaleo Chicago

River North

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Nobu Chicago

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Momotaro

Fulton Market

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Roka Akor

River North

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Sushi-san

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Tre Dita

St. Regis

new \$\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Miru

St. Regis

new \$\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Adalina

Gold Coast

new \$\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Alston

Gold Coast

new \$\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Le Colonial

Gold Coast

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Nico Osteria

Gold Coast

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Somerset

Gold Coast; Viceroy

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

NoMI

Park Hyatt

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Peninsula's Shanghai Terrace

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Pops for Champagne

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Beatnik

West Town / the river

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Ēma

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Aba

Fulton Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Cabra

Hoxton

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Girl & the Goat

West Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Monteverde

West Loop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Au Cheval

West Loop

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Publican

Fulton Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Alinea

Lincoln Park

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Ever

Fulton Market

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Oriole

West Loop

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Smyth

West Loop

★★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Next

West Loop

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Boka

Lincoln Park

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Esmé

Lincoln Park

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Indienne

River North

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Topolobampo

River North

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Sepia

West Loop

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Elske

West Loop

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Group Date night

Untitled Supper Club

River North

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Cindy's

CAA

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

LH Rooftop

LondonHouse

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Drake

Coq d'Or / Palm Court

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Time Out Market Chicago

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

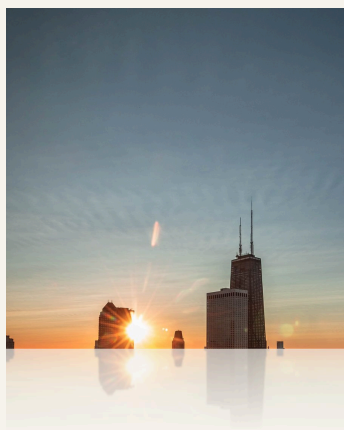
Group Date night

Soho House Chicago

Fulton Market; members

\$\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Romantic Group



Nightlife · 50 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

Smartbar since 1982, the Green Mill since 1907, and the blues rooms in between.

Smartbar under Metro since 1982, the Green Mill since 1907, Buddy Guy's, and the venues — Thalia Hall, the Salt Shed, Empty Bottle — that make this a music city before a club city.

Why these Venues and clubs together. Berlin, Double Door and Le Passage are listed closed; Podlasie Club is on because a Polish disco in Avondale is the most Chicago night out there is.

Smartbar

Wrigleyville; below Metro; since 1982

\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Metro

Wrigleyville

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Spybar

River North

\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Sound-Bar

River North

\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Prysm

River North

\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

TAO Chicago

River North

\$\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Berlin

closed

Empty Bottle

Ukrainian Village

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Thalia Hall

Pilsen

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Salt Shed

Goose Island; the venue

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Lincoln Hall

Lincoln Park

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Schubas

Lakeview

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

The Hideout

West Town

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Green Mill

Uptown; jazz

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Late night Group

Kingston Mines

Lincoln Park; blues

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Buddy Guy's Legends

South Loop

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Rosa's Lounge

Logan Square

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Jazz Showcase

South Loop; since 1947

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Andy's Jazz Club

River North

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Constellation

Roscoe Village

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Sleeping Village

Avondale

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Cafe Mustache?

closed ; use Cole's (Logan Square)

Beauty Bar

West Town

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Slippery Slope

Logan Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Debonair

Wicker Park

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Emporium

Wicker Park / Logan Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Subterranean

Wicker Park

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Double Door

closed (reopening?) — ?

Sidetrack

Boystown; the showtunes

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Roscoe's

Boystown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Hydrate

Boystown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Progress

Boystown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Cell Block

Boystown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Big Chicks

Uptown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Podlasie Club

Avondale

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Carol's Pub

Uptown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Cobra Lounge

West Town

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Reggies

South Loop

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Bottom Lounge

West Loop

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

House of Blues

River North

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Radius

Pilsen; the big room

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Riviera

Uptown

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Aragon Ballroom

Uptown

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Chicago Theatre

the Loop

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Le Passage

closed

Studio Paris

closed

Bassline

South Loop

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Punch House late

Pilsen

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Ravinia

summer

\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Evil Olive

Wicker Park

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

The Loop to Logan Square. A depression dog at noon, a Bib at eight, jazz in Capone's booth at eleven.

One day, on the L. Book one dinner. **Book one thing: dinner at Galit (Resy) or Kasama's tasting menu (Tock).**

The day

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 8:00 | Lou Mitchell's (West Loop)
Since 1923, the free Milk Duds at the door, the omelet in the skillet. Walk-in; the line is the ritual. |
| <hr/> | |
| 9:30 | The Loop
The Art Institute or the architecture boat tour — the boat is the one to book. Garrett Popcorn's Chicago mix on the way. |
| <hr/> | |
| 12:00 | Gene & Jude's (River Grove) or Al's Beef (Little Italy)
The depression dog (mustard, relish, onions, sport peppers, fries on top — no ketchup) is 25 minutes west; the dipped Italian beef is ten minutes south. Pick one. Cash is fastest at both. |
| <hr/> | |
| 2:00 | Pequod's (Lincoln Park)
One pan, the caramelized cheese crust — the deep dish locals actually eat. Walk-in; order the moment you sit. |
| <hr/> | |
| 4:00 | The Violet Hour (Wicker Park)
Behind the mural, no sign, the bar that started Chicago's cocktail revival. Walk-in; go early. Then Dorian's through the record shop next door. |
| <hr/> | |
| 6:00 | Cindy's (Chicago Athletic Association)
One drink over Millennium Park at golden hour. Resy. If it's full, the Milk Room downstairs — eight seats, vintage spirits. |
| <hr/> | |
| 7:30 | Galit (Lincoln Park) ★ or Kasama (Ukrainian Village) ★★
Galit for Zach Engel's Middle Eastern (Resy, 30 days); Kasama for the Filipino tasting menu that just earned its second star (Tock). Backup: Daisies (Logan Square, Bib + Green Star, Resy) or Lula Cafe (Resy). |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:30 | Green Mill (Uptown)
Jazz since 1907, Capone's booth, a Malört if you dare. Cash at the door. |

Three days

The Loop and Lincoln Park, then the West Side, then the South Side. One direction a day.

A long weekend. Day one is the one-day plan; day two is Fulton Market and Logan Square; day three goes south. **Book three dinners the day reservations open: Galit or Kasama, Smyth or Oriole, and Virtue.**

Day 1 · The Loop & Lincoln Park

All day **Follow the one-day plan**

Lou Mitchell's, the Loop, a dog or a beef, Pequod's, the Violet Hour, Cindy's, Galit, the Green Mill.

Day 2 · West

9:00 **Kasama (Ukrainian Village)**

The morning bakery-café — ube pastries and the longganisa breakfast sandwich. Walk-in; the line moves.

11:00 **Fulton Market**

Publican Quality Bread for a loaf to carry, Time Out Market for a look, Sawada's military latte in the West Loop.

1:00 **Au Cheval (West Loop)**

The burger. Walk-in, put your name down, expect an hour — or Monteverde for Sarah Grueneberg's pasta (Resy) if you can't wait.

3:30 **Logan Square**

The Bib row on foot: Lardon for a charcuterie plate, Cellar Door for a glass, Margie's Candies for a sundae if you've room.

5:30 **Best Intentions or Meadowlark (Logan Square)**

Both 50 Best; both walk-in early. Scofflaw for gin if you want a third.

7:30 **Smyth (West Loop) ★★★ or Oriole (West Loop) ★★**

Smyth for the only three stars in the city (Tock, weeks out); Oriole through the freight elevator (Tock). Backup: Elske ★ (West Loop; Resy) or Rose Mary (Fulton Market, Bib, Resy).

10:30 **Kumiko (West Loop)**

Julia Momosé's bar — 2024 James Beard Outstanding Bar. Resy; the counter takes walk-ins late.

Day 3 • South

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 9:30 | Manny's (South Loop)
Corned beef on rye at the cafeteria line, since 1942. Walk-in. |
| 11:00 | Pilsen
The murals on 18th Street, then Carnitas Uruapan for a pound of carnitas by weight, since 1975. Cash. |
| 1:00 | Chinatown
MingHin for dim sum, Qing Xiang Yuan for dumplings, Chiu Quon for egg tarts on the way out. Walk-in. |
| 3:00 | Bridgeport
Maria's Packaged Goods — a liquor store that's also the best bar on the South Side — and Kimski next door for Korean-Polish. |
| 5:00 | Hyde Park
Valois cafeteria for the atmosphere, the Robie House for the architecture, Plein Air for a coffee. |
| 7:30 | Virtue (Hyde Park)
Erick Williams' Southern room, a Bib and a James Beard Best Chef. Resy. Backup: Lem's Bar-B-Q rib tips in Chatham (walk-in, cash), then Calumet Fisheries for smoked shrimp if you have a car. |
| 10:00 | Buddy Guy's Legends (South Loop)
The blues, where it lives. Cover at the door. |

Five days

The three-day plan, plus the North Side neighborhoods and a day for the counters and the lake.

Enough time to eat like a resident: Devon Avenue, Uptown's Asian blocks, a tasting counter, and the lakefront. **Set alarms for Smyth, Alinea or Ever (Tock), Kasama, and Schwa's phone line.**

Days 1–3

All **Follow the three-day plan**
The Loop, the West Side, the South Side.

Day 4 · North

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 9:00 | Lost Larson (Andersonville)
Cardamom buns and the Scandinavian case. Walk-in. |
| 11:00 | Devon Avenue
The Indian-Pakistani strip: Sabri Nihari for the nihari, Uru-Swati for the vegetarian thali, the sweet shops between. Cash is fastest. |
| 1:30 | Uptown
Sun Wah for the Beijing duck ceremony (order it when you sit — it takes time), or Birrieria Zaragoza for the goat (Bib). Then the Green Mill by day for the room. |
| 4:00 | Hopleaf (Andersonville)
Belgian beer and the mussels; the back garden if it's warm. Walk-in. |
| 6:30 | Cariño (Uptown) ★
Norman Fenton's Latin tasting counter. Resy. Backup: Nadu (Lincoln Park; South Indian, Bib, Resy) or Boonie's (Filipino, Bib). |
| 9:30 | Carol's Pub (Uptown)
Honky-tonk, live country, cash. Or the Whistler in Logan Square for jazz in a tiny room. |

Day 5 • The counters, and the lake

10:00 **Lula Cafe (Logan Square)**

The Sunday brunch that defined Chicago's neighborhood restaurant, since 1999. Resy, or a wait.

12:30 **The lakefront**

Rent a bike on the Lakefront Trail from North Avenue Beach to Montrose. Castaways or the Dock for a beer if it's summer.

3:30 **Offshore (Navy Pier)**

The largest rooftop bar in the world, for one drink and the skyline. Resy.

5:30 **Schwa (Wicker Park) ★ — the phone**

Call. Keep calling. If Michael Carlson answers and has a seat, cancel everything else. Otherwise —

8:00 **Alinea ★★ or Ever ★★ or Next ★**

Alinea for Grant Achatz's theater (Tock; the Salon is the accessible seat); Ever for Curtis Duffy and the best service in the city (Tock); Next for whatever the menu is this season (Tock). All weeks out. Backup: Esmé ★ (Lincoln Park; Tock).

11:00 **Smartbar (Wrigleyville)**

Beneath Metro, since 1982, the best sound system in the city. Or the Milk Room if you'd rather end quietly.

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

Tock was invented here — learn it.

Alinea's co-founder built Tock, so the tasting counters (Alinea, Smyth, Ever, Oriole, Next, Kasama, Schwa's neighbors) sell tickets in blocks, often prepaid and non-refundable. Set alerts. Resy runs the rest, 30 days out. Schwa takes reservations by phone only; the line is legendary.

Deep dish vs tavern-style.

Tourists eat deep dish (Lou Malnati's, Pequod's, Giordano's); Chicagoans eat tavern-style — thin, square-cut, from Vito & Nick's, Pat's, Marie's. Try both. Never call deep dish 'a pie' out loud.

No ketchup on a hot dog.

The Chicago dog is mustard, relish, onion, tomato, pickle, sport peppers, celery salt on a poppy-seed bun. The depression dog (Gene & Jude's) skips the tomato and pickle and adds fries. Asking for ketchup will be noted.

Cash at the stands.

Gene & Jude's, Jim's Original, Johnnie's Beef, Carnitas Uruapan, most of Devon and Maxwell Street Market, and the Green Mill's door are cash-first. Carry \$60 on the neighborhoods days.

Tip 20%; tax is 11.75% downtown.

Chicago's restaurant tax is among the highest in the country — 10.75% citywide, 11.75% in the downtown zone. Menus exclude it. Some restaurants add a service charge; read the bill.

The L runs all night on two lines.

The Red and Blue lines run 24 hours; the others stop around 1am. Tap in with a contactless card (Ventra is optional). Late in Logan Square or Pilsen, the Blue and Pink lines get you home; the South Side after midnight is a car.

Winter is the point, and the problem.

November to March the rooftops, the Riverwalk and the beach bars close; the Green Mill, the steakhouses and the tasting rooms don't. Summer is the season: Ravinia, the lakefront, Wrigley bleachers, Maxwell Street on Sunday.

Monday is dark.

Alinea, Smyth, Oriole, Ever, Kasama's tasting menu and most chef rooms close Sunday and Monday. The hot-dog stands, Chinatown and the taverns run seven days.

Use the Amex credit like a local.

Platinum \$100 per quarter, Gold \$50 twice a year, at any Resy or Tock venue showing the 'Resy Credit eligible' badge. Tock's counters now count — a prepaid Alinea ticket is the easiest \$100 you'll spend.

Anything marked verify, verify.

Chicago lost Berlin, Double Door, Lost Lake, Passerotto, Fat Rice and Xoco within a few years. A minute on Resy or Google before you take the L across town.

Malört.

Jeppson's Malört is a wormwood liqueur that tastes like regret. A shot will be offered to you at some point as a test. Take it once.

One for the road.

O'Hare's Terminal 3 has a Tortas Frontera (Rick Bayless) that is the best airport food in America; Terminal 1 has Garrett's. Midway has a Harry Caray's and a Nuts on Clark.

Notes

Michelin: the 2025 Chicago selection, announced November 18, 2025 as part of the Northeast Cities guide — twenty stars. Smyth is the city's only three-star; Alinea moved down to two after more than a decade at three, alongside Ever, Oriole and Kasama, which was promoted; fifteen one-stars, including Feld, new with a Green Star. Daisies holds a Green Star with its Bib. Thirty-three Bib Gourmands, with Mirra, Nadu and Taqueria Chingón added. Amy Cordell of Ever received the Michelin Service Award. The 2026 selection is expected late 2026.

Bars: Kumiko won the 2024 James Beard Outstanding Bar award and is Chicago's 50 Best regular; Best Intentions (Nº25), Meadowlark (Nº38) and Bisous (Nº39) held 2025 North America's 50 Best rankings — their 2026 placings weren't confirmed for this edition. Calumet Fisheries holds a James Beard America's Classics award.

Occasion chips for Chicago are editorial assignments, by category and price. Tock — invented here for Alinea — runs most of the tasting counters; Resy the rest. The Amex credit works at both.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): three photographs, cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listede ville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.